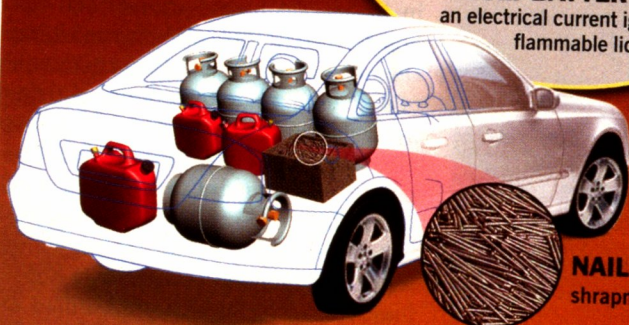
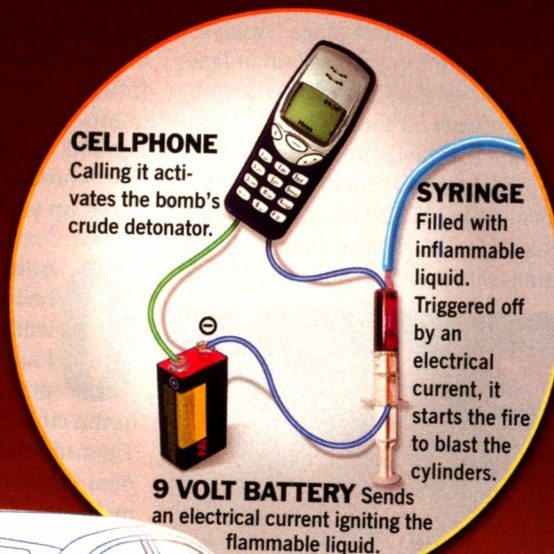


Graphic by RAM

WHY DID THE BOMBS FAIL?

PLAN A: Two cars packed with fire-bombs were left outside a night club. A syringe was connected to a battery and a mobile phone to activate the firebomb. Once the mobile is rung, an electrical circuit was to be completed, igniting the flammable liquid in the syringe. But despite multiple calls, the bombs failed to go off—most likely due to the faulty syringes.



NAILS Packed in cars as shrapnel to kill and maim.

PLAN B Kafeel and Bilal filled an SUV with propane cylinders, set it on fire and drove it into the airport. The flames were doused before the cylinders could 'cook off' in the blaze.



while Bilal had used his fists and feet to stop anyone from getting close to the vehicle. "I'll never forget that burning man running towards me, lashing out," Campbell, 49, told reporters.

By the time the passenger was subdued, the driver was "well ablaze—clothing, hair, skin—and from the attitude that he was in, lying on his back, there was a kind of resignation about him." "I was free to act," the policeman said, "so, knowing where the fire extinguishers were in the building, I grabbed one and just began to spray." Within minutes, the two men were on the ground, under arrest. The Doctors' Plot was over, but

global investigations into the botched plan continue.

Kafeel is believed to have burnt himself so as not to be arrested and complete his martyrdom. The original plan merely called for remotely detonating the car bombs and then returning to India—he had entrusted his parents with a CD which he would collect after completing the 'project'. His suicide note describes the motive and grievances that led to the attack, but police have refused to reveal the contents yet. Just as the Australian police have yet to reveal the exact reasons for the arrest of Haneef in Australia two days after the Glasgow attack. He

was arrested before he could board a flight on a one-way ticket to Bangalore. Haneef's family in Bangalore insists he is paying the price of giving his mobile phone SIM card to Sabeel when he left Britain. But Australian police are reportedly in possession of tapes of Haneef discussing suicide bombings. National Security Adviser M.K. Narayanan has meanwhile asked the Research and Analysis Wing and Intelligence Bureau to study the implications of the Bangalore bombers on India's security. It is based on Prime Minister Manmohan Singh's concern that the episode could not cast a shadow on Bangalore, dissuading the foreign investors flocking the city and affecting the IT personnel of Bangalore most sought after the world over.

Bangalore police, meanwhile, are awaiting an analysis of the hard disk and the CDs of the 320-GB capacity computer retrieved from the home of the Ahmeds since they moved in from Saudi Arabia. The computer reported to have 12,000 files and 5,000 emails, besides speeches in praise of bin Laden and the jihadi movement is being examined by investigators. The Thiruvananthapuram-based Resource Centre for Cyber Forensics, part of the Centre for Development of Advanced Computing (C-DAC), is ferretting out details of Kafeel's hard disc and a CD he gave his parents. The city police are trying to piece together the puzzle. Did the brothers set up sleeper cells in the city to fund missions and seek new recruits? Was Haneef a conduit in Australia for raising funds for the entire operation? Police are also looking for clues to the trio's affiliation with fundamentalist Muslim bodies like the Indian Muslim Mohammedi Mujahideen.

The contents of the computer, investigators believe, could hold clues as to whether the brothers had anything to do with the attack on the IISc campus in 2005 or other terror activities in Bangalore. Clearly, the case of the Bangalore bombers will continue to throw up more questions than answers in the days to come.

with Sandeep Unnithan, Stephen David and Aditi Khanna